

How to improve your accent/enunciation as an Indian.

- Many Indians sound “Indian” in English not because of vocabulary or grammar, but because of **how the mouth moves**.
- Indian languages use **different muscles** than English when we speak.
- Our native tongues usually involve **less lip and jaw movement**, and a **flatter tongue position**.
- English requires **wider lip control, jaw opening, and precise tongue placement** for its sounds.
- If you don’t move your mouth enough, your speech sounds **unclear, flat, or unnatural** in English.
- Even with perfect grammar, a misused mouth shape can lead to “Sorry, can you say that again?”
- The goal isn’t to “sound white” — it’s to sound **clear, confident, and globally understood**.
- You can **retrain your mouth muscles** like you would train in the gym: repetition, pressure, and stretching.
- The tools are already in your face: your **lips, tongue, jaw, and breath** — you just have to use them differently.

To **fix this**, you need to **press, push, stretch, and control your articulators** (mouth parts that shape sound).

Treat speaking like a **physical workout** — because it is.

Here’s how to start, even if you’ve never thought about how you speak before:

1. Exaggerated Mouth Movements (Daily for 10 minutes)

- Stand in front of a mirror.

- Take a sentence from a book, news article, or YouTube subtitle.
 - Read it **slowly and dramatically**, opening your mouth more than usual.
 - Example: Say “The weather is beautiful today” like you’re acting in a slow-motion movie.
 - Stretch every vowel and clearly hit every consonant.
 - Yes, it feels weird — but it works.
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2. Pen-in-Mouth Reading (5 minutes daily)

- Place a pen **horizontally between your teeth**, gently but firmly.
 - Read a paragraph out loud, trying to speak clearly even with the pen.
 - After removing the pen, read the same paragraph again.
 - Notice how much clearer and stronger your voice sounds.
 - This builds **mouth endurance** and sharpens enunciation.
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3. Learn the Sounds of English (Phonemes)

- Hindi has **44–50 distinct sounds**, and most are pronounced exactly as written.
- English also has **around 44 sounds**, but many are **silent, combined, or blended**.
- Example: “Knight” is spelled with 5 letters but only has 3 spoken sounds.
- Indian languages are **syllable-timed**; English is **stress-timed** — that’s a big difference in rhythm.
- Learning English phonemes helps your **brain connect sound to shape**, which helps your mouth produce them better.
- This is how you avoid common mistakes like saying “fool” instead of “full” or “wery” instead of “very”.